

freedom and better options – but it's up to me to decide what to do with that freedom and those options.

I asked my Instagram audience recently about why they wanted more money. It seems quite a basic question, but I largely find that the assumption in society is that, if offered more money without any sort of significant sacrifice, most people would say yes. I wanted to tap into people's motivations and get an idea of any recurrent themes or motivations as to why people pursue extra income or more wealth. The answers, though not surprising at all, were at odds with the spending and consumption behaviours that most of us exhibit in our daily lives. Most responses centred around freedom and security, which I've found tend to go hand in hand, even though we might associate freedom with spontaneity and security with routine. Almost everyone, aside from a woman who wanted to be able to buy more outfits for her dog without being judged by her partner (one of my favourite ever responses), had some sort of simple, longer-term, non-material purpose to their wish for more available funds. Many answers stated that they would like to feel more relaxed about money, some wanted to save for a house – having somewhere safe to live being fairly high up in Abraham H. Maslow's hierarchy – while others expressed a wish to travel more, be able to save for their children, clear debt and afford further education or a new career. All of these are related to wellbeing, happiness and fulfilment in a way that the pursuit of material wealth and possessions is not, and yet we consistently see, and ourselves